THE MANDARIN



Ryan Meinerding concept art.

In the comic books, the Mandarin comes from pre-revolutionary China, and—since his introduction by Stan Lee and Don Heck in 1964—has been villainously dogging Iron Man's steps for nearly five decades. Marvel Studios placed his origin closer to home for *Iron Man 3*.

"Shane was very specific about what he wanted for the Mandarin," Visual Development Supervisor Ryan Meinerding explains. "He liked the idea of a terrorist that came from our culture. Someone scarier because he might've started off as something like a CIA agent, but then went rogue and created his own ideology and purpose. He would understand what America fears about terrorists—and use propaganda as a tool to frighten, undermine, and disturb the world."

